# 2008 Honda Accord DX

$2,000 · 200,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/4377425409058398/

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder







| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$2,353** | **$389** | **Good** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 4/5 · 9 recalls · 1,521 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $2,000.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $185.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $13.00 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $32.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $2,353.00 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $2,353.00 |
| Amount financed | $0.00 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $2,503.00 |

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $0.00 |
| Insurance (estimate, liability) | $70.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 25 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $190.00 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $115.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $13.58 |
| Total per month | $388.58 |

Running costs without the loan: **$389/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$7,166** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Good (4/5)**

The 2008 Accord's 2.4L 4-cylinder and 5-speed automatic are very durable; at 200k it's about how it was maintained.

NHTSA data for this model year: 9 recalls · 1,521 owner complaints (62 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (574), Hydraulic (451), Air Bags (379), Engine (210), Exterior Lighting (113), Electrical System (105).

**Known issues for this model**

• Oil consumption on some 2008-2012 2.4L engines

• VTC actuator rattle on cold start

• Rear brakes wear fast

• A/C compressor

**Check on this car before buying**

• Oil level/consumption

• Rattle on cold start

• Wheel studs/hub on the damaged wheel (and that the other wheels are torqued right)

• Smooth shifts

• Seller provides smog certificate

## Notes

IN-TOWN CAR (~$3k, for getting to and from work in Ridgecrest; not a DoorDash pick).

$2,000 FIRM or trade, ~200k mi, 4-cyl VTEC automatic, grey/black. CLEAN TITLE IN HAND, 2 owners, paid off. Listed 2026-10-28.

NOT DRIVABLE AS-IS: 3 lug nuts/studs broke off on the passenger side. Cheap fix (~$50-150 for studs + nuts) - do it on the spot with a mobile mechanic or tow it. Seller needs it gone ASAP.

Best value of the in-town options. Check the oil level: the 2.4L can burn oil at high miles.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.